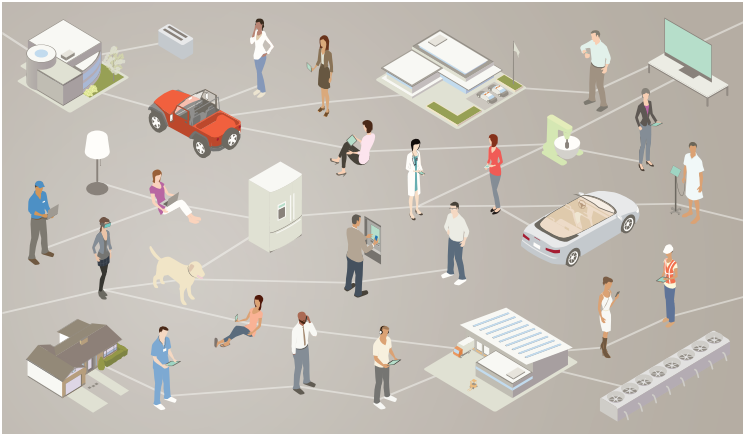


There are already refrigerators that tweet their contents, cars that auto notify emergency services in the event of a crash, and even a keychain you can locate with your phone (Yay! No more lost keys!). All of these devices are part of this huge ecosystem where they are constantly sharing data over the internet.

Of course, where data and scale are involved, Google cannot be far behind, so in 2017 they launched the Internet of Things Solutions and Android Things (initially named project Brillo), an OS tuned to be used in IoT devices that lets developers harness all the power of the Android ecosystem and ensures security and ease of use.

Currently, Android Things is in beta, and supports about 5 hardware platforms, including Intel Edison, the Intel Joule and the Raspberry Pi 3. One thing to note here are that all of these are devices with virtual memory,



For a data-based market like IoT, Google definitely has an advantage

meaning Google is only targeting fully capable IoT devices, and not the simple microprocessor based ones which limits their reach on the market.

The OS is also fairly heavy to load and has a boot-up time in the range of a couple of minutes, which also presents a problem since many IoT devices would be used in situations where such delays are not acceptable.

However, the capabilities of the OS and the ability to seamlessly use the existing Android APIs would hopefully be enough to create a much more able system that is closer to smartphones rather than the simple IoT devices that we see in the market today.